

Cover Letter – Ingestion Team Lead at Airbnb

Yongjun Rong

Cherry Hill, NJ 08003

rongyj@hotmail.com

856-408-4027

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/rongyongjun/>

Date: [Current Date]

Airbnb

[Company Address]

[City, State ZIP]

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Ingestion Team Lead position at Airbnb. Your mission to connect people through authentic stays and experiences resonates deeply with me, and I am inspired by the opportunity to help power Airbnb's data-driven business by building and operating world-class data ingestion systems.

Why I'm Excited About Airbnb

Airbnb's scale and impact are truly remarkable, and the Ingestion team's mission to provide reliable, performant, and scalable data export platforms is both technically challenging and business-critical. I am passionate about architecting and operating distributed systems that enable organizations to unlock the value of their data, and I am eager to contribute my expertise to help Airbnb continue to innovate and grow.

Relevant Experience & Impact

Distributed Systems & Data Ingestion - Over 20 years of experience building and operating large-scale backend distributed systems for enterprise and SMB clients (Barclays, McKinsey, Biophy, Yotascale, Boomi, etc.) - Hands-on experience designing and operating data ingestion pipelines, including real-time change data capture (CDC), batch exports, and data warehouse integrations - Deep familiarity with distributed database internals, data warehouse systems, and cloud-native infrastructure (AWS, Kubernetes, Docker) - Experience with Spark, Kafka, and large-scale data processing frameworks

Technical Leadership & Collaboration - Led and mentored teams of engineers to deliver multi-quarter, cross-functional projects, driving technical vision and execution - Collaborated closely with internal customers, product teams, and leadership to deliver impactful solutions and influence long-term strategy - Provided technical guidance, established best practices, and raised operational standards for data ingestion and distributed systems

Operational Excellence & Ownership - Demonstrated strong ownership in planning, delivering, and supporting mission-critical data platforms - Proactively identified, debugged, and resolved operational issues, and participated in on-call rotations to ensure reliability - Wrote clean, maintainable, and testable code in Python, Java, and Scala

Why I'm a Strong Fit for Airbnb

My experience architecting and operating large-scale data ingestion systems, combined with my technical depth in distributed databases and my passion for empowering organizations through data, positions me to make a significant impact on Airbnb's Ingestion team. I thrive in collaborative, fast-paced environments and am eager to help shape the future of Airbnb's data infrastructure.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and vision align with Airbnb's mission and how I can contribute to your continued success.

Sincerely,

Yongjun Rong